INCH-POUND

MIL-B-44430(GL)
5 September 1991

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BREAD STUFFING, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers bread stuffing, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, U.S. Army Soldier Systems Command, Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SSCNC-WRE, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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MIL-L-35078 - Load, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION ACENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRIGULTURE (USDA)

Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products (7 CFR Part 59)

(Copies are available from the Director, Poultry Standardization Branch, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, Room 3944, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

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AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121).

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 650 California Street, Suite 800, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 – Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Eggs, whole, liquid or frozen. Whole eggs may be liquid or frozen and shall have been processed in accordance with Regulations Governing the Inspection of Eggs and Egg Products (7 CFR 59). The whole eggs shall be egg

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whites and egg yolks in their natural proportions as broken directly from the shell as evidenced by a USDA Egg Products Inspection Certificate. For liquid whole eggs, the certificate shall state the time of pasteurization. Liquid whole eggs shall be held at temperature of 40^0F or lower and shall be held for not more than 72 hours from the time of pasteurization until the start of formulation of the product in which they are used. Frozen whole eggs shall be held at 10^0F or lower and used within 120 days from the date of production. The whole eggs shall be free from off-odors, off-flavors, or foreign odors and flavors, such as metallic, musty, sour, or fruity, and free from foreign material.

3.2.2 Bread, white, enriched. Bread shall be commercial, soft crumb, enriched, white bread. The bread shall possess a flavor, aroma and texture that is typical of soft crumb, white bread. The commercial white bread should have a moisture content of 38.0 percent; however, if this moisture requirement is not met, the moisture can be adjusted to 38.0 percent requirement as described in 3.3.3, footnote 1. The bread shall have a protein content of not less than 8.0 percent, fat content of not less than 1.4 percent, and carbohydrate content of not less than 50.0 percent.

3.2.3 Oil, vegetable. Vegetable oil shall possess a clean, bland flavor, have a minimum stability of 15 hours (A.O.M.), have a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.05 percent, have a moisture/volatile matter content not to exceed 0.06 percent, and pass a cold test of 5.5 hours (minimum).

3.2.4 Onions, dehydrated, chopped. Dehydrated chopped onions shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.5 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined sodium chloride, with or without anti-caking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.6 Celery, dehydrated, sliced. Dehydrated celery shall be obtained from clean, sound Pascal type celery. The slices shall be approximately 3/8 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The dehydrated slices shall be free-flowing, shall possess a uniform bright color, and shall have a moisture content of not more than 5.5 percent.

3.2.7 Flavoring, roast chicken, natural and artificial. Natural and artificial roast chicken flavoring shall be dry, free-flowing powder composed of chicken fat, disodiuminosinate and dry chicken meat (see 6.4).

3.2.8 Pepper, black, ground. Ground black pepper shall have been ground from the deep brown to black, deep-set, wrinkled, immature berries of Piper nigrum L. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor and a light gray to speckled black-gray color. The ground pepper shall contain not less than 2.0 ml of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground black pepper and be of such size that 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 16 sieve.

3.2.9 Sage, ground. Ground sage shall be the dried leaves of Salvia officinalis L. The ground sage shall be green to grayish-green in color; shall possess a strong, fragrant, aromatic odor, and a slightly bitter taste. The ground sage shall contain not less than 1.5 ml of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground sage and be of such size that no less than 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve.

3.2.10 Thyme, ground. Ground thyme shall be derived from the dried leaves and flowering tops of Thymus vulgaris L. and shall possess a fragrant aromatic odor and an aromatic minty flavor. The ground thyme shall contain not less

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than 0.8 ml of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground thyme and be of such size that not less than 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

3.2.11 Oregano, ground. Ground oregano shall be derived from the dried leaves of Origanum vulgare L. and shall possess a strong camphoraceous aroma and a pungent, slightly bitter flavor. The ground oregano shall contain not less than 2.0 ml of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground oregano and shall be of such size that 95 percent, by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

3.2.12 Celery, fresh. Celery shall be fresh, crisp, white (blanched) or green variety. The celery shall be free from pithy branches, seed stems and damage.

3.2.13 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.14 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.15 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of frozen whole eggs. Frozen whole eggs shall be tempered to 28^0F to 40^0F and held in the temperature range of 28^0F to 40^0F for not more than 24 hours prior to product preparation.

3.3.2 Preparation of fresh celery. The fresh celery shall be cleaned thoroughly, trimmed to remove fibrous longitudinal strands and sliced in 1/4 inch cross-cut stalk slices with no leaf cuts. The sliced celery shall be blanched in 180^0F to 190^0F water for two minutes. The blanched celery shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled drained celery shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and filled into the tray pack can within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.3 Preparation of bread stuffing. The bread stuffing shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Water	32.82
Bread, white 1/	29.50
Eggs, whole	28.00
Vegetable oil	5.00
Onion, dehydrated, chopped	2.50
Salt 2/	0.75
Celery, dehydrated, sliced 3/	0.50
Flavoring, roast chicken	0.53
Pepper, black, ground	0.07
Thyme, ground	0.04
Sage, ground	0.02
Oregano, ground	0.02
Lecithin	0.25

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1/ The moisture content of the bread used in the formulation shall be determined before combining with the above ingredients. If the moisture content is determined to be greater than 38 percent, that amount in excess shall be deducted from the percent water in the formulation. If the moisture content is less than 38 percent, adjust the formulation with the required amount of water.

2/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements.

3/ If fresh celery is used, the percent by weight shall be adjusted to 2.75 and the water shall be adjusted to 30.57.

a. Combine all ingredients in the mixer and mix only until there is even product distribution and the bread is broken into small but recognizable pieces.

b. Filling of the product into tray pack cans shall be a continuous operation. Filling shall be completed within 1 hour after product preparation. The time allowed from product preparation to can filling may be extended to 4 hours provided the product is held under refrigeration in the temperature range of 28^0F to 40^0F during this time. In addition, the mixture shall be periodically stirred during can filling to prevent settling.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements.

a. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to assure compliance with the finished product requirements (see 3.6).

b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a minimum sterilization value (f_0) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as, but not limited to, glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, or stale.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

f. The product shall have a light brown to yellow surface.

g. The product shall possess a moderate chicken flavor and have a slight savory odor and flavor.

h. The product shall have a moist, dense, grainy, interior and a spongy

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texture.

i. No individual tray pack shall have a fat content greater than 12.0 percent.

j. The average fat content shall be not greater than 10.0 percent.

k. The salt content of any individual tray pack shall be not less than 1.0 percent nor greater than 1.5 percent.

l. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched.)

m. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans must show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

n. The product shall have a light yellow interior.

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packing or Holding of Human Food", and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this document. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1,

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components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process inspection. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation, or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight or the net weight of any individual can is less than specified in 3.6, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Double sampling plan for product inspection. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I utilizing the double sampling plans indicated in MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be expressed in tray pack cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed tray pack can. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0 for major defects and 6.5 for minor defects. The sample cans shall be heated in accordance with the heating instructions on the can label.

TABLE I. Product defects. 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
102		Product does not possess a moderate chicken flavor, or does not possess a slight savory odor or flavor.
103		Product does not possess a moist, dense, grainy interior and spongy texture.
104		Evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).
	201	Product surface not light brown to yellow.

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202	Product interior not a uniform light yellow.

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

3/ Interior of filled and sealed cans shall be examined visually for coating defects during product examination. Suspected rust spots shall be verified by testing in accordance with 4.5.7. Any spot verified as a rust spot shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Any scratch or fracture that penetrates through the coating of a can shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4/ The contents of each sample can shall be divided into ten approximately equal portions and examined for appearance and texture characteristics.

4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. Three filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Meat and Meat Products, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened tray pack cans shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat and salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, scratches, scuffs, or abrasions that occur on the outside coating as a result of the filling, sealing, and thermoprocessing of the tray cans shall not be scored as a defect.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4) except, for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closure shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer’s requirement and 21 CFR, Part 113, subpart D, or 9 CFR, Part 318, Subpart G, as applicable. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

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4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to $75^0F \pm 5^0F$, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. One measurement shall be made when examining a ribbed lid; lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangements or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping of pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1), except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses

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having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C Packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (for example, EST 38) or a three digit letter code identifying the establishment
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production, and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1990 would be coded as 0078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above. In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4.1 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 30 – 40 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

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TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350^{0}F oven 30 – 35 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 2/3 cup each.

As an alternate labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack cans shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition documents. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

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6.4 Flavoring, roast chicken, natural and artificial. It has been found that Natural Roasted Chicken Flavor Powder R-9016 WONF, manufactured by Haarmann and Reimer Corporation, P.O. Box 175, Springfield, NJ 07081-3119; Chicken Flavor G86X35, manufactured by Gen Trac Incorporated, 2232 Evergreen Road, Middleton, Wisconsin 53562; and Natural Chicken Flavor WONFP-12,664, manufactured by Crompton and Knowles Corporation, 17-01-G Nevins Road, Mahwak, New Jersey 07430 meet the requirements of 3.2.7 and performs satisfactorily in this product.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned food
Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational rations
Shelf stable

Custodians:

Army – GL
Navy - SA
Air Force – 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-A696)

Review activities:

Army – MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

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